Little Fox Readers

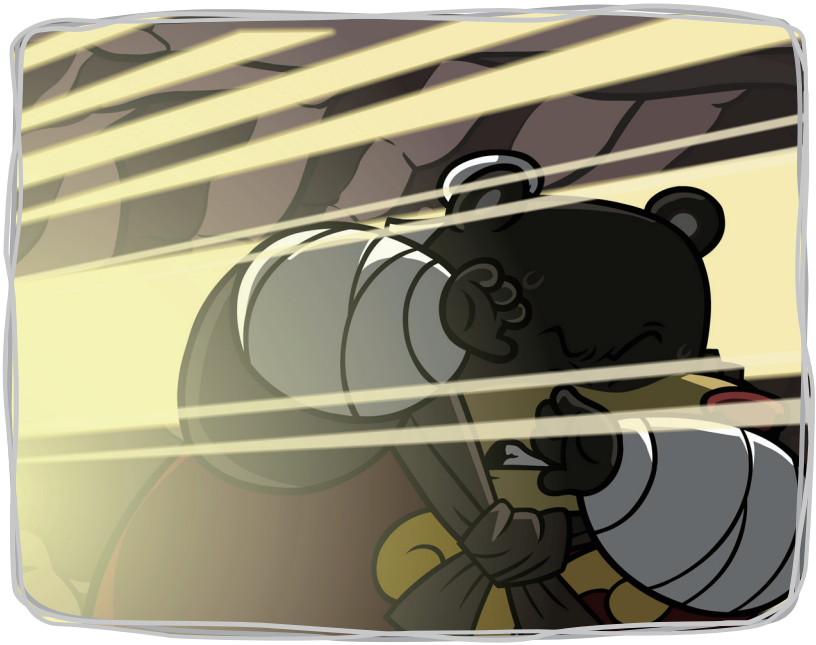
Level 5

JOURNEY to the WEST 22

A Very Strange Pill



Little Fox



The Black Wind King took a step back. He looked confused. “That pill jumped down my throat!”

The entire cave filled with light. The bear squeezed his eyes shut. When he opened them, Guanyin was standing before him.

“Guanyin!” the bear cried. “You tricked me with a disguise!”

“Return the robe at once,” said Guanyin.

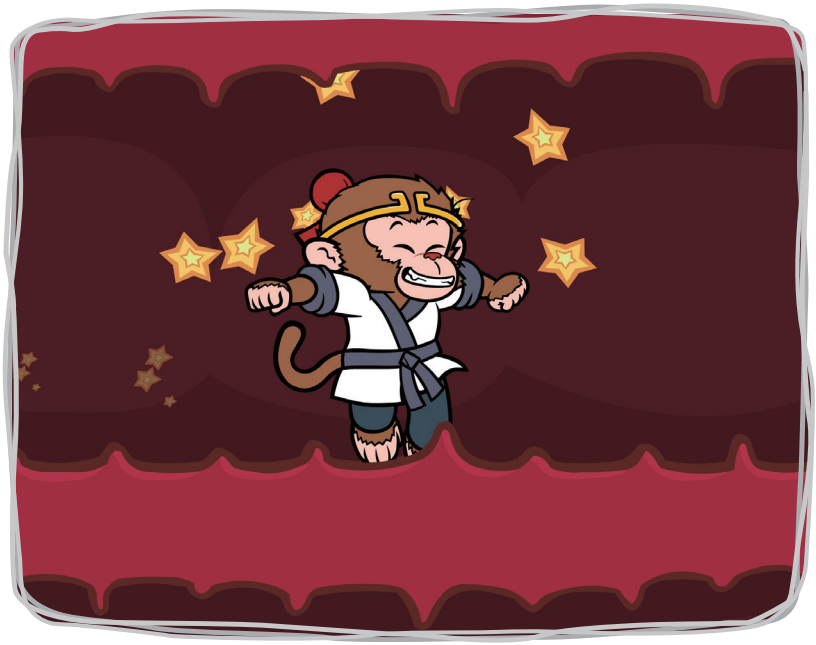


"No," said the Black Wind King. "I don't want to . . . Ugh." He held his stomach and groaned.

"Are you feeling okay?" asked Wukong's voice.

The bear looked around, surprised. "I just heard the monkey!" He fell to his knees and groaned again. "Where are you?"

"I'm inside you!" said Wukong. "I



changed myself into a pill to trick you. Now I'm going to practice some of my fighting skills!"

The monkey punched and kicked the bear's insides. *Boomph! Pow! Boomph! Pow!*

"Aargh!" cried the Black Wind King, rolling on the floor.

Wukong jumped up and down, did flips, and ran around in circles.



“Please stop!” shouted the Black Wind King. “You’re hurting my belly!”

“Give back the robe,” said Guanyin.

“I will, I promise!” said the bear. “I will do anything you say! Just please tell the monkey to stop!”

Guanyin held up a metal headband. It looked just like the one on Wukong’s head. She placed it on the bear’s head.



“Wukong, come out now,” said Guanyin.

A tiny Wukong popped out of the Black Wind King’s nose. He quickly grew to his normal size.

“Where’s the robe?” asked the monkey.

The bear pointed to a dark room in the back of the cave.

After Wukong left to get the robe, the Black Wind King charged at Guanyin.



But the bear was too slow. Guanyin threw four more metal bands at him. Two clamped onto his wrists. The other two clamped onto his ankles.

When the bodhisattva began reciting a spell, the bear screamed. “Please stop!”

“Do you promise to be good?” asked Guanyin.

“Yes!” answered the Black Wind King. “I



promise."

Wukong came back with the robe. When he saw the bear, he laughed. "You have five of those bands!"

The Black Wind King looked at the ground and sighed.

"I got the robe, Bodhisattva," said the monkey. "What should we do with the bear?"

"I will show him mercy," said Guanyin.



“He can be my guardian on Mount Potalaka if he behaves.”

The bodhisattva led the bear out of the cave and vanished.

* * *

Wukong flew back to the monastery.

“You got the robe!” cried the Tang Monk when he saw the monkey.



"I did," said Wukong.

The two travelers headed west again. Wukong told the monk about his adventure with the Black Wind King.

"I destroyed the Daoist priest," the monkey explained. "He was really an evil wolf spirit. Then Guanyin made herself look like him."

"And you turned yourself into a pill," said

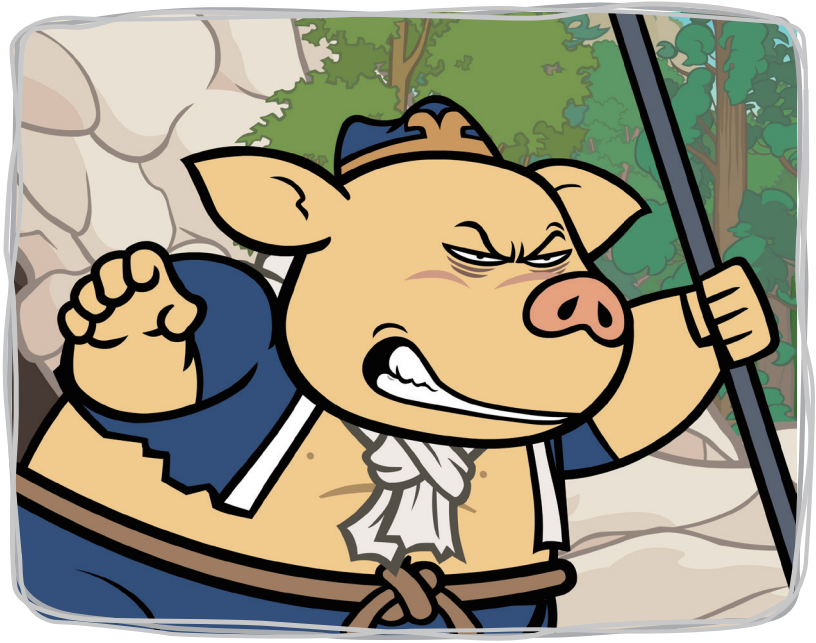


the Tang Monk.

"And I went right into that bear's belly." Wukong laughed. "He was very surprised!"

The Tang Monk smiled. "I think we both learned a valuable lesson, Wukong. I will never show anyone the robe again."

"That's a good idea," said Wukong. "The robe is a gift from Buddha. We must be careful . . ." He stopped talking and pulled



out his iron bar. “There’s a spirit nearby.” He looked toward a nearby cave.

There was a snort. The Tang Monk shook with fear.

A pig-like creature leaped from the cave, swinging a heavy rake.

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